significance in today's Pakistan. She is clear in her view that, 'having space for Bhagat Singh in Pakistan's narrative will lead to a more mature polity', not least because, 'if Bhagat Singh is inducted in Pakistan's history books and made a national icon like Iqbal and Jinnah, then young Pakistanis seeking more freedom and equality will be more empowered', because speaking as a Pakistani herself, 'Singh's presence will force us to question some of the historical suppositions made when teaching the history of Partition and the Pakistan Movement'.[1]

Small wonder then that on 25 April 2016, the Punjab Government in Pakistan announced that it would bear the entire expenditure of the purchase of Shaheed Bhagat Singh's house and its conversion into a world-class memorial at Chak No. 105 GB (now Banga village) in Lyallpur, Pakistan. In April 2018, the chief secretary of Pakistan's Punjab province went on to call Bhagat Singh a 'hero of both India and Pakistan'. He is therefore now unmistakably a shared hero of both India and Pakistan, prompting notable writers on Bhagat Singh to ask, 'What's there in Bhagat Singh that can bring India and Pakistan together? Is it his ultimate martyrdom or something more that recommends him as a common hero?' with a view to inquiring into how the two nations can move away from the 'divisive politics' and 'narrow jingoistic politics' that have plagued both nations since their inception and turned them into sworn enemies despite a common bond of land and ancestry. India's distinguished public intellectual, S. Irfan Habib, has argued that it is 'his distinctive political and social ideals' which mean that today, 'Singh is probably the only one from amongst our freedom struggle heroes who can be celebrated by both India and Pakistan'. The reason for that is quite simply because 'he stood for a non-sectarian and egalitarian world' and had 'never espoused any divisive idea in his short life'. [2]

In 1924, when he was barely seventeen, Bhagat Singh published his first article in *Matwala*, a Hindi magazine from Calcutta, and wrote on 'universal brotherhood'. He imagined a world in which 'all of us being one and none is the other. It will really be a comforting time when the world will have no strangers'.[3] In hindsight today, this is indeed the very polar